ISSUE 62

OCTOBER 26, 2026

LAST WEEK IN TÜRKİYE

A weekly roundup of the top news and developments in Türkiye

MARCH 19 PLATFORM
UNITED FOR DEMOCRACY IN TÜRKİYE

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OCTOBER 26, 2026

REMINDERS BY NUMBERS

586 DAYS

since Istanbul Mayor and opposition preseidential candidate Ekrem İmamoğlu was jailed. His trial is still ongoing.

89 DAYS

since elected Üsküdar Mayor Sinem Dedetaş was jailed pending trial, despite not being convicted of any crime.

31 DAYS

since retired police officer Ali Şekeroğlu committed suicide during a protest over pensioners' financial struggles in front of the Constitutional Court

494 DAYS

since attorney Mehmet Pehlivan was arrested. He remains imprisoned despite the reported expiration of the maximum legal period for pretrial detention.

JAILED BOLU MAYOR DENIES CORRUPTION, FACES 217 YEARS

Suspended Bolu Mayor Tanju Özcan denied corruption allegations during the third hearing of his trial involving 19 defendants, four of whom remain imprisoned. Prosecutors are seeking a sentence of 69.5 to 217 years on charges including extortion, bribery, and aggravated fraud. Appearing remotely from prison, Özcan maintained his innocence, defended the municipality’s charitable activities, criticized the proceedings, and pleaded for his release, saying he wanted to return home to his family.

COURT ORDERS ÖZEL TO PAY GÜRLEK DAMAGES OVER PROPERTY CLAIMS

An Istanbul court ordered YENİ Party leader Özgür Özel to pay Justice Minister Akın Gürlek 750,000 Turkish lira in non-pecuniary damages over allegations that Gürlek owned 16 properties. The court partially upheld Gürlek's lawsuit and dismissed Özel's countersuit. Separately, allegations concerning Gürlek's property purchases, financial transactions, and asset declarations were referred to judicial authorities for examination. The allegations remain unproven

JOURNALIST İSMAİL ARI REARRESTED AFTER RTÜK OFFICIAL'S COMPLAINT

BirGün reporter İsmail Arı was arrested on October 21 after voluntarily appearing at Ankara police headquarters following a complaint by former RTÜK Chairman Ebubekir Şahin. Accused of publicly spreading misleading information and insulting a public official, Arı was detained over alleged flight and evidence-tampering risks. He criticized the proceedings, claiming the judge disregarded his defense. Arı had previously spent 75 days in prison following his arrest in March.

TÜRKİYE SUSPENDS THREE INVESTMENT FIRMS' CAPITAL MARKET OPERATIONS

Türkiye's Capital Markets Board (SPK) temporarily suspended the capital market activities of Alnus Yatırım, Bulls Yatırım, and Pusula Yatırım, effective October 21, 2026. The regulator also fined HSBC Yatırım approximately 354,804 Turkish lira for inadequate procedures concerning unclaimed assets. Separately, SPK removed Metas Gayrimenkul from its list of authorized property valuation firms and approved Fiba Yatırım's issuance of up to 1 billion lira in bonds and commercial paper.

OCTOBER 26, 2026 *ANKA HABER*

OPPOSITION DEMANDS ACCOUNTABILITY FOR 455,700 FUND SCANDAL VICTIMS

During parliamentary debates on legislation addressing Türkiye's investment fund crisis, opposition lawmakers questioned the government's proposed "voluntary repayment" mechanism for those accused of profiting improperly. YENİ Party MP Ümit Özlale asked why identified beneficiaries were not immediately prosecuted. Lawmakers demanded disclosure of alleged beneficiaries, scrutiny of financial regulators, and full compensation for approximately 455,700 affected investors. MP Özgür Karabat described the scandal as a failure of the governance system.

PROSECUTOR SEEKS CONVICTIONS FOR İMAMOĞLU, EIGHT OTHERS IN CHP CASE

In a trial concerning alleged irregularities at the Republican People's Party's (CHP) 38th Congress, prosecutors sought convictions for nine defendants, including imprisoned Istanbul Mayor Ekrem İmamoğlu, Özgür Çelik, and Rıza Akpolat. Prosecutors requested acquittals for Cemil Tugay and two others, citing insufficient evidence. Several witnesses testified that they had neither witnessed misconduct nor received financial inducements. İmamoğlu's lawyer challenged the allegations. The hearing was adjourned until November 11.

ALTINBAŞ EXECUTIVES DETAINED, FAMILY ASSETS FROZEN IN FUND SCANDAL

Turkish authorities detained 26 suspects, including Altınbaş Holding Chairman İnan Altınbaş and board member Nusret Altınbaş, in an expanding investigation into alleged stock market manipulation. Prosecutors ordered the freezing of the Altınbaş family’s assets and issued detention warrants for 31 individuals. The investigation concerns suspicious transactions involving shares of four publicly traded companies. Türkiye’s Capital Markets Board (SPK) had previously filed criminal complaints against 37 individuals over alleged market irregularities.

İYİ PARTY LAWMAKER RESIGNS OVER NATIONALISM DISPUTE

Ankara MP Ahmet Eşref Fakıbaba resigned from İYİ Party and parliament after party leader Müsavat Dervişoğlu demanded his departure. The dispute followed Fakıbaba's remarks supporting Türkiye's peace process and describing himself as a liberal and a "Turkish nationalist" rather than embracing the traditional nationalist slogan "How happy is the one who says 'I am a Turk.'" Dervişoğlu declared that anyone unwilling to repeat the slogan had no place in the party.

HUMAN RIGHTS ASSOCIATION DEMANDS KAVALA'S RELEASE AFTER EUROPEAN COURT RULING

Türkiye's Human Rights Association (İHD) called for a demonstration outside Silivri Prison on October 23, demanding Osman Kavala's release and compliance with European Court of Human Rights rulings. On October 13, an Istanbul court rejected Kavala's requests for retrial and release despite an August 2026 ruling. Imprisoned since November 2017, Kavala is serving an aggravated life sentence. The European Court previously ruled that his detention violated human rights and ordered his release.

MANIFEST FOUNDER TOLGA AKIŞ FACES UP TO THREE YEARS IN PRISON OVER OBSCENITY CHARGES

Istanbul prosecutors have indicted Tolga Akış, founder and manager of Turkish pop group Manifest, seeking six months to three years in prison on obscenity charges. Prosecutors allege he organized and promoted performances deemed harmful to traditional family values and children. Separately, former collaborator Mesut Adlin accused Akış of restrictive contracts, financial exploitation, and interference in band members' personal lives. Akış denied the allegations, defending the group's contractual arrangements and financial practices.

COURT RULES ISTANBUL ANTI-WAR PROTEST BAN VIOLATED RIGHTS

Türkiye’s Constitutional Court ruled that Istanbul’s 2020 blanket ban on demonstrations opposing military operations in Syria violated the constitutional right to peaceful assembly. The court found that authorities relied on vague security concerns without providing concrete evidence of threats to public order. It emphasized that even controversial or disturbing opinions must be protected unless they incite violence. The court awarded the applicant 5,000 Turkish lira in compensation.

FORMER AKP LAWMAKER DETAINED IN TÜRKİYE FUND SCANDAL

Ertan Aydın, a former AKP lawmaker and presidential adviser credited with developing Erdoğan's 2023 campaign slogan "Türkiye Century," was detained in an expanding stock market investigation. All 31 suspects sought by İstanbul prosecutors are now in custody. Aydın previously served on Tera Holding's board. The investigation, based on Capital Markets Board reports, examines alleged irregularities in share transactions involving four publicly traded companies.

CONSTITUTIONAL COURT FINDS RIGHTS VIOLATION OVER WRONGFUL SOLITARY CONFINEMENT

Türkiye’s Constitutional Court ruled that prisoners lack an effective legal remedy for damages caused by disciplinary punishments later overturned. The case involved Metin Yamalak, who served 12 days in solitary confinement in 2008 for using the expression “Dear Öcalan” in a petition. His punishment was annulled in 2021. Finding a violation of the right to an effective remedy linked to freedom of expression, the court awarded 40,000 lira in compensation and referred the systemic issue to parliament.

AMNESTY INTERNATIONAL URGES CANADIAN PRIME MINISTER TO RAISE HUMAN RIGHTS DURING TÜRKİYE VISIT

Ahead of Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney's visit to Türkiye, Amnesty International urged him to prioritize human rights alongside trade and strategic relations. The organization highlighted the detention of elected mayors, judicial pressure on opposition figures, and restrictions targeting journalists, activists, and LGBTQ+ groups. Amnesty also called for the immediate release of Osman Kavala, imprisoned since 2017 despite European Court of Human Rights rulings, and demanded stronger protections for fundamental freedoms.

AKP SUES JOURNALIST ZAFER ARAPKIRLI AND BIRGÜN OVER FUND SCANDAL COVERAGE

Türkiye's ruling Justice and Development Party (AKP) has filed a 600,000 TL ($14,000 approximately) defamation lawsuit against BirGün newspaper and journalist Zafer Arapkirli. The party alleges that Arapkirli's commentary linking AKP figures to the ongoing fund scandal damaged its reputation and exceeded the limits of press freedom. Arapkirli had questioned the government's responsibility and criticized alleged political connections to the financial scandal.

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